> form of the nation-idea which they acknowledge to have been originally entirely foreign to the Indian mind.
>
> The evidence further demonstrates that at least a few of the writers have perceived the profound significance upon the origins of the movement of socialising agencies carried into the land by the British; it seems to suggest that in the course of time Indian writers and commentators will tend increasingly to emphasise the influence of the British-born institutions which have tended to bear upon every part of the social fabric, rather than those institutions having a strictly political character.

Sadly, McCully's prognosis of the future was prophetic since, to me, it certainly seems that in contemporary Bharat there are more voices, even among 'experts', which endorse and echo McCully's views on Bharat's history than those that subscribe to the Indic school of thought. Clearly, the study of history and its representation is not as neutral and objective as is often made out to be. The irony is that the colonial consciousness of the Indian mind is best captured by the fact that the very same views expressed by Sarda, Mookerji, Sarkar and Majumdar and others[29] on the civilisational character of Bharat[30] and its cultural unity[31] are welcomed and received with a lot more enthusiasm when a book titled *India: A Sacred Geography* is written by Diana L. Eck.[32] Perhaps, the colonial consciousness of the Indian mind is put at ease by the fact that a white Westerner, and that too a professor of comparative religion and Indian studies at Harvard University, has recognised the sacred nature of Bharat's geography and appropriately caveated her position with standard-issue expressions of the fear of her work feeding the 'fervor of an exclusive new Hindu nationalism'. Since all the right boxes have been ticked in the mind of the colonialised Indian, both the messenger and the message are kosher or halal.

In a nutshell, there are typically only two acceptable choices for those who wish to understand Bharat's history—they must either subscribe to that school of thought which denies Bharat's antiquity, unity and Indic consciousness, or accept the view which recognises the validity of Bharat's indigenous OET, with the caveat that 'Hindu nationalism' must be exorcised from the Indian mind. And preferably, voices belonging to either school must not be Indian, and if they are Indian or of Indian origin, their credentials must be certified and validated by Western academia. There is a